AA-O-230/4a
October 7, 1964
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. AA-O-00230/4
February 7, 1964 and
Fed. Spec. AA-D-198
March 6, 1951

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

OFFICE FURNITURE: DESK, EXECUTIVE TYPE, WOOD, TRADITIONAL, (DETAILED SPECIFICATION)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the detailed requirements in traditional design for executive type office desks. General requirements and other information pertaining to the desks will be found in Federal Specification AA-O-230, Office Furniture, Executive Type, Wood, Traditional (General Specification.)

1.2 Classification. The desks covered by this specification shall be of two types

1.2.1 *Types and sizes* The types and sizes of the desks shall be as follows:

Type I—Executive.

Size 1—60 inches wide by 34 inches deep by 30 inches high.

Size 2—66 inches wide by 40 inches deep by 30 inches high.

Size 3—72 inches wide by 48 inches deep by 30 inches high.

Size 4—78 inches wide by 48 inches deep by 30 inches high

Type II—Secretarial.

Size—60 inches wide by 34 inches deep by 30 inches high.
(Desk heights do not include glides.)

Note. The base assembly of the type I, size 2 desk shall be used as the base for the type I, size 4 desk.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATION, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 The specifications and standards, of the issues in effect, on date of invitation for bids, which form a part of this specification, will be found in 2.1 of Federal Specification AA-O-230, hereinafter called the General specification.

2.2 Other publications. Other publications, which form a part of this specification, will be found in 2 2 of the General specification

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TABLE I.—*Material references*

AA-O-230 Par. No.	Component	AA-O-230 Par. No	Component
3.2.2	Adhesives	3 2.4	Filler
3.2.3	Wood	3.2 5	Lacquer
3 2.3.1	Kinds of wood	3.2.6	Hardware
3.2.3.2	Solid Wood	3.2.6.1	Face hardware
3.2 3.3	Plywood	3.2.6.2	Locks
3.2.3.3 1	Matching of veneer plies	3.2.6.2 1	Strike-plate
3.2.3 4	Seasoning, all wood parts	3.2.6.3	Composition glides
3.2.3.5	Varieties of wood	3 2 6.5	Other hardware

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. Preproduction sample requirements shall be in accordance with 3 1 of the General specification.

3.2 Materials. The materials used in the construction of the desks shall be of the kind and quality specified in 3 2 of the General specification. The paragraph numbers for the various components referenced in the General specification are listed in table I

3.3 Construction. The general construction requirements of the desks and their component parts shall be as specified in 3 3 of the General specification. The paragraph numbers for the various components as found in the General specification are listed in table II

3.3.1 *Design* The design of the desks shall be as shown in the applicable figures as follows:

Type I—Figure 4(1), 4(2) (Except overhang on Size 4 desk).

Type II—Figure 4(5), 4(6)

3.3.2 *Direction of grain.* The grain pattern shall be as shown in the applicable figures

TABLE II—*Construction references*

AA-O-230 Par No.	Component
3.3.2	Tolerances
3 3 4	Joining and assembly
3 3 5	Gluing of joints
3 3.8 2	Dowels
3 3 9 1	Posts
3 3 9 2.1	Bracket foot base
3 3 9.2 3	Clamp nails
3 3 9 2 4	Base support

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3.3.3 *Drawers.* The drawers shall conform to 3.3.6 of the General specification and shall be as specified herein. Each center top drawer (over knee space) shall run on a center drawer-guide and the runner shall be neatly fitted, glued and secured with screws to the front and back rails in true alignment The second drawer from the top in the type II desk shall be arranged to accommodate stationery as shown in figure 4(6) The lower drawer in the right hand pedestal of the type I desk shall be double height and fitted with a metal follower and track operating lengthwise of the drawer. The follower (compressor) shall be parallel to the drawer sides, and the drawer sides shall be grooved for a dove-tailed partition which shall be easily adjustable for filing either letter-size or legal size papers. This drawer shall be of a design that will appear as the two lower drawer fronts in the opposite pedestal The shallow top pedestal drawer in the type I and type II desks shall be fitted with two movable partitions so spaced as to provide three equal sections for each drawer All other drawers of the type I and type II desks shall be fitted with one movable partition, and three movable slotted partitions, located as shown in figure 4(3). The center drawer in all desks shall be fitted with a convenience tray of the design shown in figure 4(2) This tray shall be secured to the drawer bottom with screws. All pedestal drawers, except the shallow top drawers, shall be equipped with two metal brackets with roller bearings at the top of the drawer back, and shall run on roller bearings inserted in the front posts All pedestal drawers shall be fitted with two-prong brass or bronze pulls of the design shown in figure 4(4). The drawers shall be fitted with a 2½ inches by ½ inch thick, solid or plywood baffle board to prevent papers from sliding over the back.

3.3.3.1 *Drawer openings.* The height of the drawer openings shall be as follows:

Right pedestal—Type I, all sizes:

Bottom, or letter-file—11-5/8 inches high.

Center, or storage—5-7/16 inches high.

Top, or utility—3-3/16 inches high.

Left pedestal—Type I, all sizes,

Drawer pedestal—Type II:

Three lower storage—5-7/16 inches high.

Top, or utility—3-3/16 inches high

3.3.3.2 *Drawer depths.* The depths of drawers shall be as follows:

Type I, size 1—27 inches

Type I, sizes 2, 3, and 4—30 inches

Type II—27 inches.

3.3.3.3 *Drawer locks* The center drawer of all desks shall be equipped with a lock and strike-plate as specified in 3.2.6.2 and 3.2.6 2.1 of the General specification. All desks shall be equipped with a locking device, controlled by one lock, capable of locking all pedestal drawers in one operation. When in an unlocked position all drawers shall open and close easily. Typewriter compartment doors shall not have a key. In any order up to 200 desks there shall be no duplication of keys.

3.3.4 *Slotting.* The desks shall be slotted through the drawer runs, and provided with an opening at the left or right pedestal of each type II desk as specified.

3.3.5 *Compartment door.* The compartment door shall be made to imitate the drawer fronts in the opposite pedestal, and shall be hinged to the outside leg with concealed hinges, permitting the door to open to a right angle to the front of the desk. The inside surface of the door, when open, shall be flush with the inside leg to allow full clearance for the typewriter bed The

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door shall be stopped at a right angle by a sliding brass or bronze catch attached both to the door and to the top of the bottom rail. The door shall be provided also with a ball catch at the top and bottom.

3.3.6 *Typewriter platform mechanism.* The typewriter platform shall be horizontally located and shall provide ample clearance for all standard non-electric correspondence model typewriters. The platform shall remain in a firm operating position with or without a typewriter The mechanism shall operate smoothly and with a minimum of effort during raising and lowering with the typewriter in place on the platform. There shall be a minimum of vibration when the typewriter is in use. The platform mechanism shall include a simple metal locking device which shall lock automatically when the platform is raised to the operating position.

3.3.7 *Plywood parts*

3.3.7.1 *Desk tops.* The desk tops shall be 5-ply, lumber-core construction, not less than 1⅜ inches finished thickness with solid molded edges as shown in figure 4(3). The corners shall be chamfered and the border veneers set at 45° angles, with the direction of the grain reversed at each axis. The grain match of the borders shall start at the axis. The same grain pattern shall be used for the entire border. The width of the borders shall be as shown in figures 4(1) and 4(5). The width of the solid edges shall be governed by the dimensions of the chamfered corners. The tops shall be positioned and attached as specified in 3.3 8 1 of the General specification.

3.3.7.1.1 *Dowels for tops.* The dowels for positioning the top shall be as specified in 3.3 8 2 of the General specification

3.3.7.2 *Desk slides.* Desk slides shall be 5-ply, lumber-core plywood, 13/16 inch thick, faced on two sides The four edges shall be banded with solid walnut over which the top and bottom cross-banding and face veneers shall be applied. The grain of each edge piece shall run lengthwise.

3.3.7.3 *Typewriter platform.* Each typewriter platform shall be 5 ply, 1¼ inches thick, and shall be 17⅞ inches long by 17⅝ inches wide. A ½ inch thick front stop which extends ⅜ inch above and below the platform shall be provided. This front stop shall be tongue and grooved along the entire front edge of the platform. A ¾ inch backstop which extends 2¼ inches above the platform shall be provided. The side edges of the platform shall be made of solid wood and the grain shall run lengthwise.

3.3.7.4 *Panels* All lower desk panels shall be 7-ply, lumber-core plywood, 13/16 inch thick. The upper panels shall be either solid walnut 1-1/16 inches thick or 5-ply, lumber-core plywood, 13/16 inch thick.

3.3.7.5 *Typewriter compartment door.* Each door shall be 5 ply, 13/16 inch thick, and shall be corebanded on four sides with 1½ inch wide (minimum) solid walnut The grain shall run lengthwise

3.3.7.6 *Dust shields and bottoms* The dust shields and bottoms shall be 3-ply, not less than 3/16 inch thick, hardwood plywood. The dust shield over the knee space shall be framed into the rail and drawer runs and secured with cleats. The dust bottoms on the underside of the desks shall be securely fastened with glue and cleats. (See figure 4(4).)

3.3.7.7 *Pedestals.* The desk pedestals shall be constructed as shown in the figures and shall be securely fastened to the framing members with No. 12 screws spaced not more than 15 inches apart and penetrating the top to a depth of 1 inch minimum Alternatively, suitable metal fasteners countersunk on the underside of the desk may be used

3.4 **Methods of finishing** The methods

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of finishing shall conform to 3.4.1 of the General specification.

3.5 **Color and appearance of finish.** The appearance of the finish shall be as specified in 3.5 of the General specification.

3.6 **Identification marking.** Identification marking shall be as specified in 3.6 of the General specification.

3.7 **Workmanship.** Workmanship shall conform to 3.7 of the General specification.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling, inspection, and test procedures shall be as specified in section 4 of the General specification.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

For civil agency procurement the definitions and applications of the levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std No. 102.

5.1 **Packaging.** Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A or B.*

5.1.1.1 *Drawers.* All drawers shall be immobilized by the use of clips or other suitable means of fastening. The clips shall be faced with cushioning material to prevent scratching or marring of the finished surfaces. Locks shall not be used to fasten the drawers. Keys shall be placed in an opening Kraft envelope and securely fastened to the inside surface of the center drawer.

5.1.1.2 *Cushioning.* Each desk shall be cushioned on the top, sides, front and back with pads or blankets of macerated paper, wood-fiber, or with cellulose wadding conforming to PPP-C-843, type II. The cushioning material shall be secured in place with pressure-sensitive tape.

5.1.2 *Level C.* The desks shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice.

5.2 **Packing.** Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.* Each desk, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be covered with a shroud constructed of material conforming to UU-P-271, class H or M. All seams of the shroud shall be sealed with adhesive conforming to MIL-A-140. The shrouded desks shall be packed in any of the containers conforming to the following specifications at the option of the contractor:

Specification	*Type or class*
PPP-B-591	Class II
PPP-B-601	Overseas type
PPP-B-621	Class 2
PPP-B-640	Class 2, grade A
PPP-C-650	Type A, covered

5.2.2 *Level B* Each desk shall be positioned on a wood frame base constructed of not less than 1 by 2½ inch lumber with not less than one diagonal brace. A fiberboard cover made from material conforming to PPP-F-320, type CF, grade 350 shall be placed over each desk. The side and end panels of the fiberboard cover shall extend below the bottom of the wood frame base not less than 2 inches. That portion of the side and end panels expending below the wood frame base shall be scored and under folded and nailed or stapled to the bottom of the wood frame. The top of the fiberboard cover shall be an extension of the side and end panels forming inner and outer flaps, and shall completely cover the top of the desk The flaps shall be sealed in a closed position with tape or adhesive.

5.2.3 *Level C* The desks shall be packed in containers of the type, size and commonly

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used for the purpose, in a manner that will insure acceptance by common carrier and safe delivery at destination. Shipping containers shall comply with the rules and regulations of carriers as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 **Marking.**

5.3.1 *Civil agencies* In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123

5.3.2 *Military.* In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. **NOTES**

6.1 **Intended use.** The executive office type desks in traditional styling were designed for use in executive offices, courtrooms, libraries, and conference rooms of Federal agencies. The desks should compliment the traditional decor of executive areas when used with other furniture items within the group.

6.2 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, symbol and date of this specication

(*b*) Title, symbol and date of the General specification.

(*c*) Type and size, if applicable.

(*d*) When preproduction samples are not required.

(*e*) Level of packaging

(*f*) Level of packing

(*g*) Marking requirements.

6.3 **Transportation description.** Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rails:

Desks, wooden, with enclosed pedestals on either side of open knee space, not more than 15" from floor, SU.

Carload minimum weights:

In cars 40'9" or less in length, inside measurements, 10,000, 12,000, 15,000, 18,000, 22,000, and 30,000 pounds

In cars exceeding 40'9" in length, inside measurements, 16,000, 18,000, 21,000, 24,0000, 30,000 and 40,000 pounds

Motor:

Desks, wooden, with enclosed pedestals on either side of open knee space, not more than 15" from floor, SU.

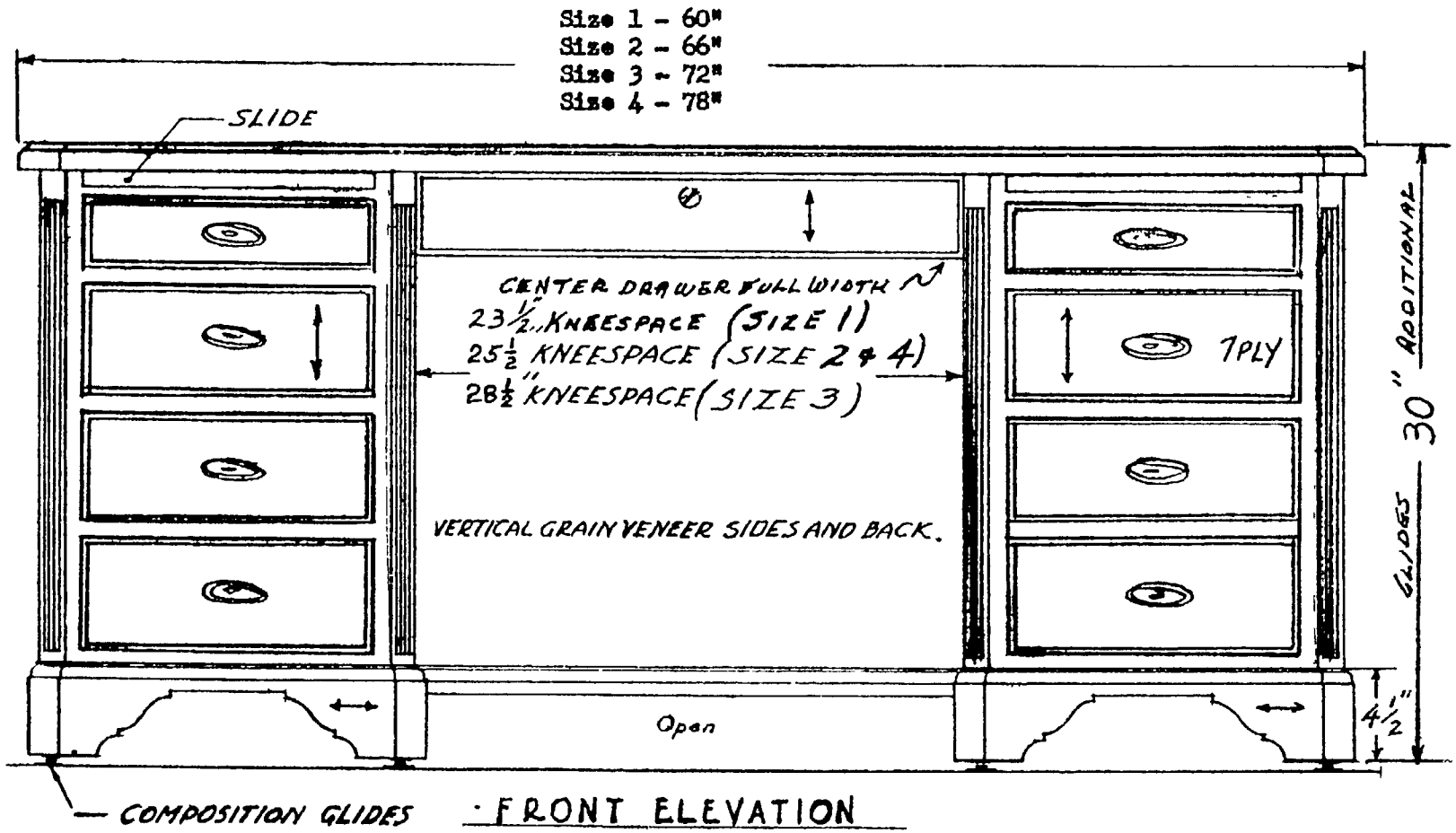
Truckload minimum weights—10,000, 12,000, 15,000, 18,000, 22,000 and 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

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Figure 4(1). Type I, Executive Desk

Size 1 - 60"X 34"X 30"
2 - 66"X 40"X 30"
4 - 78"X 48"X 30"
Corner posts - 2" X 2"
Top border width - 3"
Two slides

Size 3 - 72"X 48"X 30"
Corner posts
2-3/4" X 2-3/4"
Top border width - 3-1/2"
Four slides



AA-O-230/48

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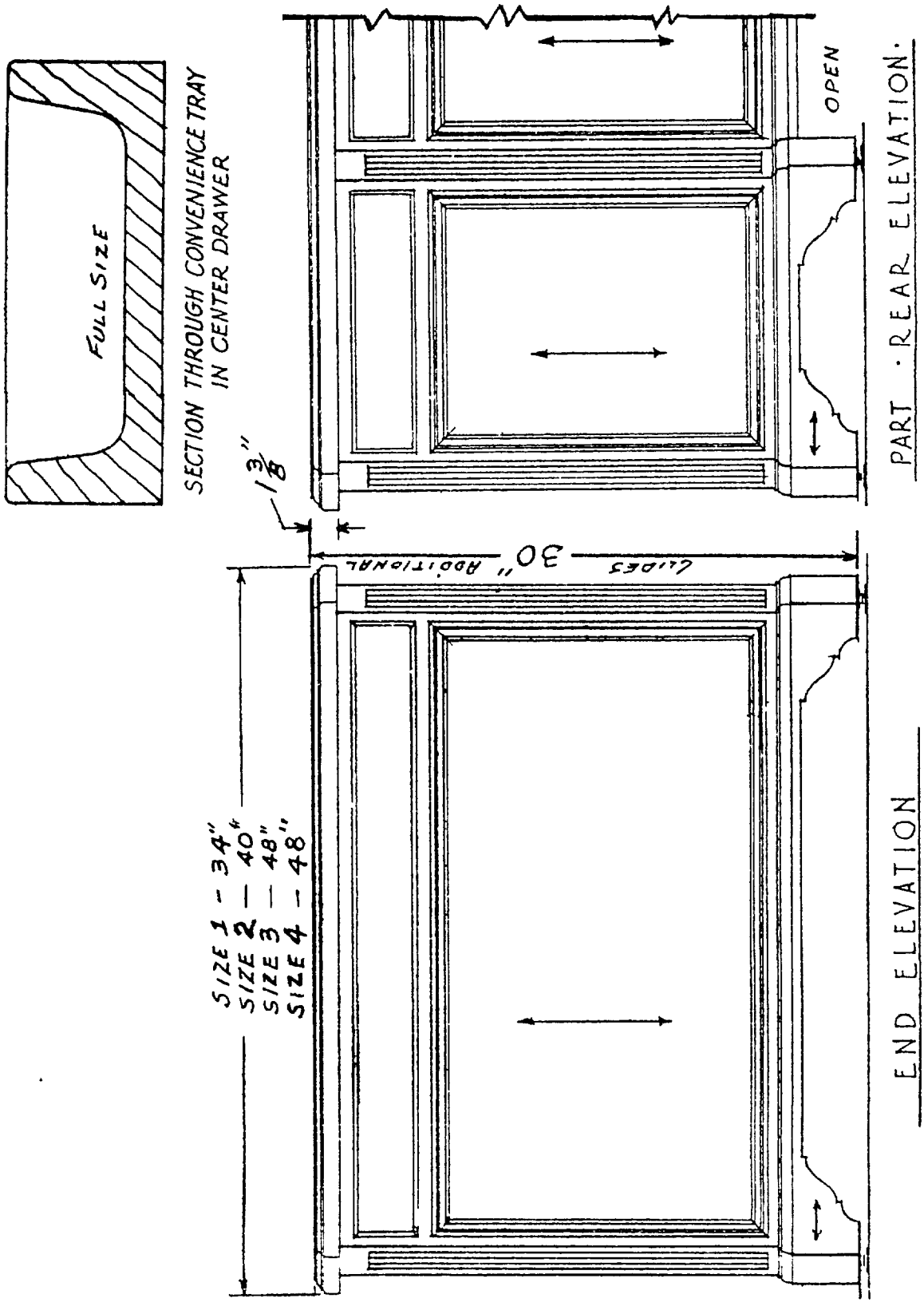
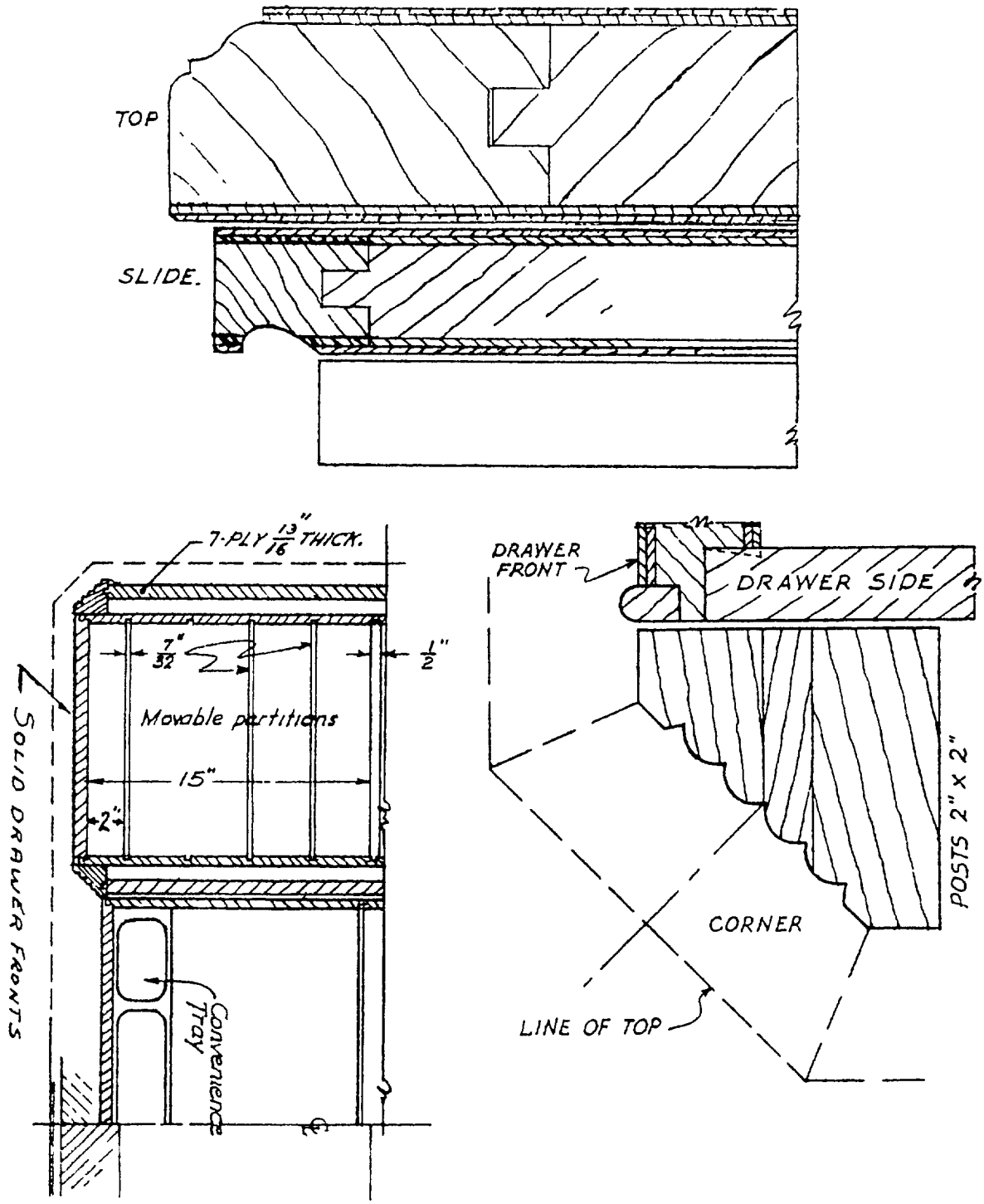


Figure 4(2). End and Side Elevation Cross Section of Tray

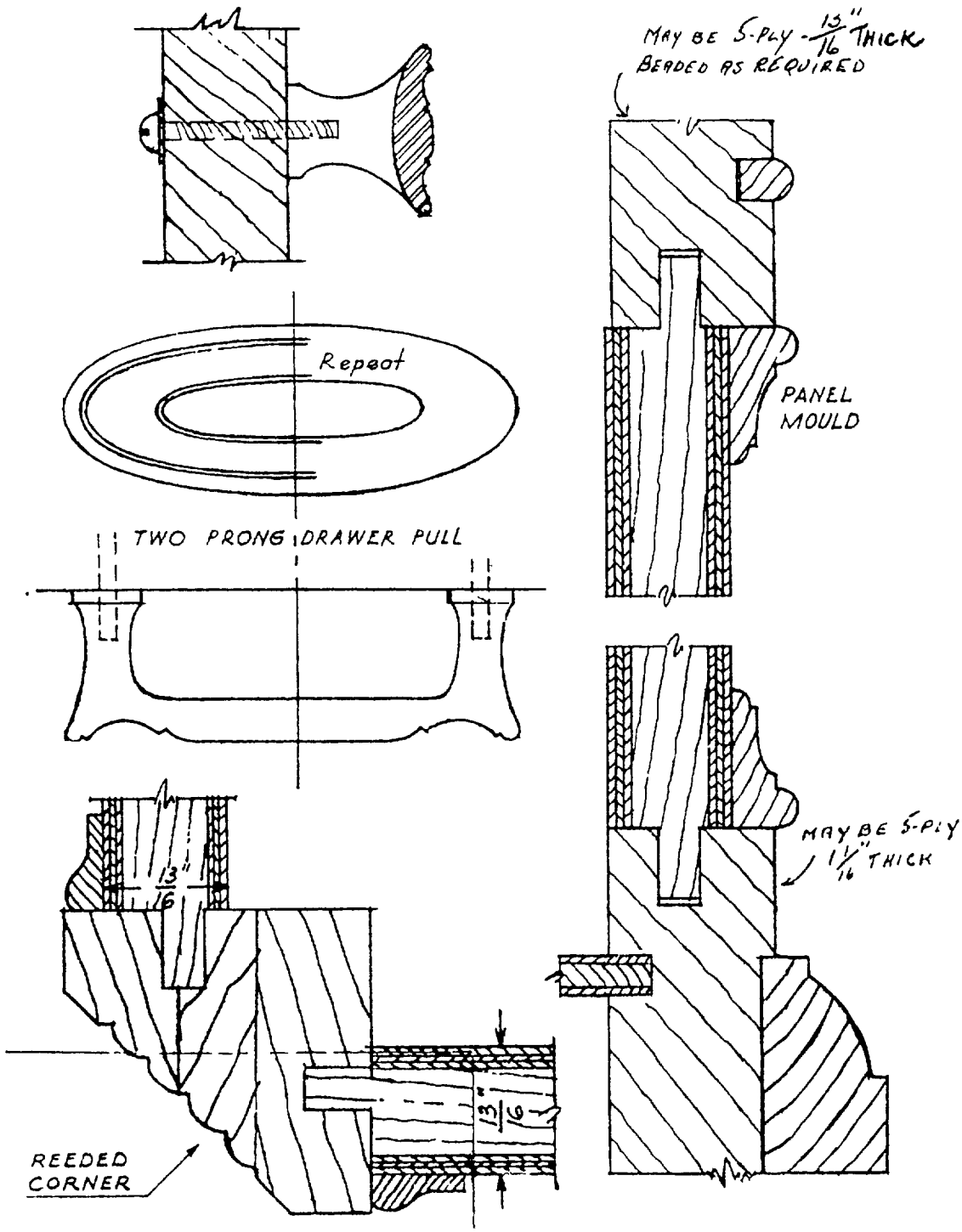
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Figure 4(3). Top, Slide and Corner Section Drawer Cutaway



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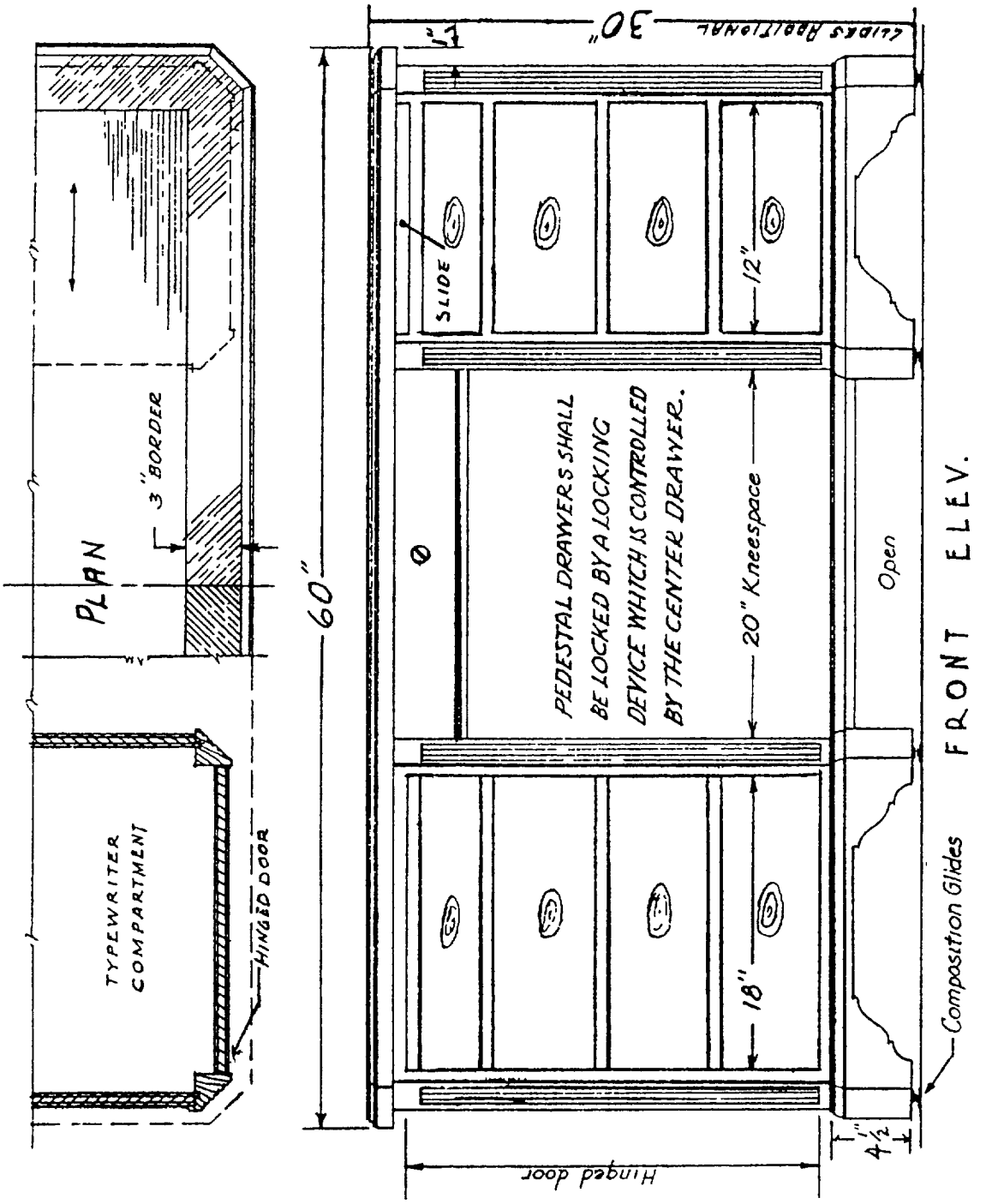
Figure 4(4). Side Panel, Corner Section, and Pull



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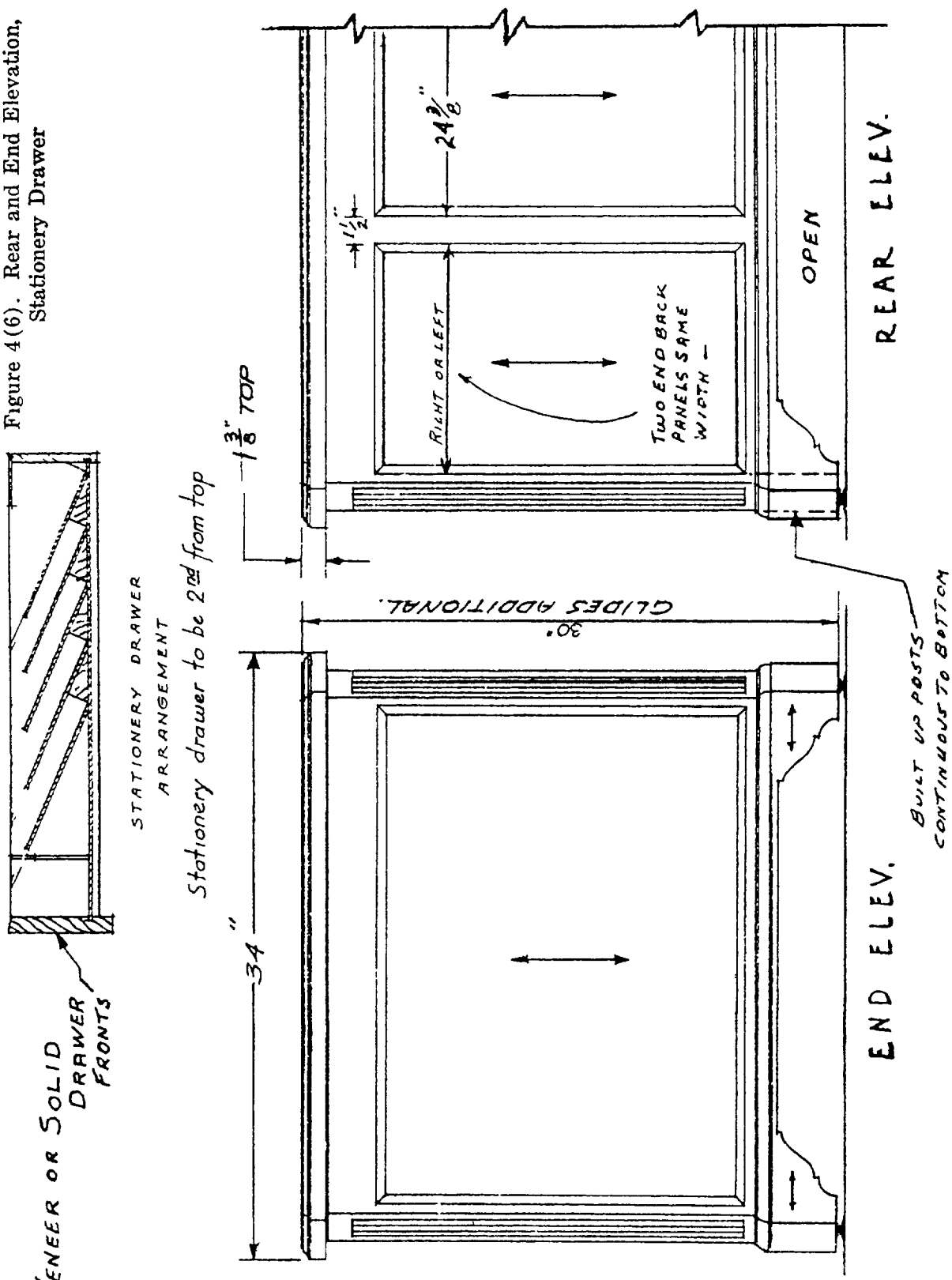
Figure 4(5) Type II, Secretarial Desk Chamfered Corner—Bracket Base

Size.- 60" X 34" X 30"



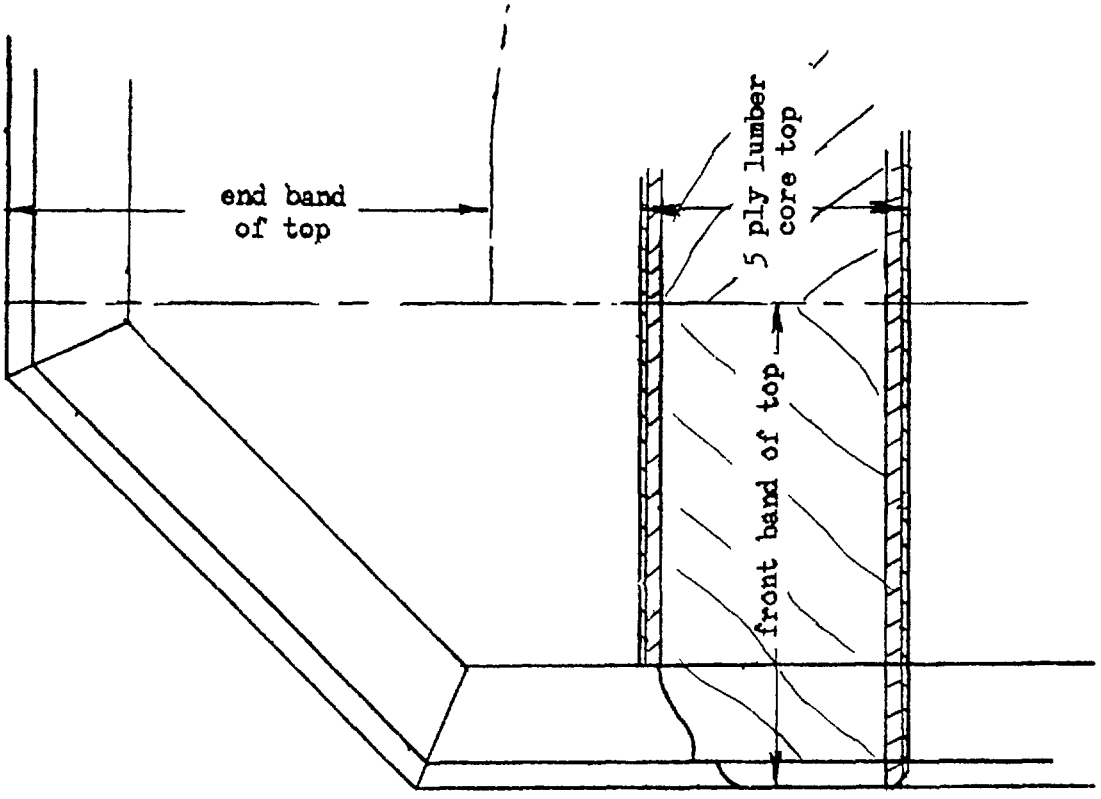
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Figure 4 (6). Rear and End Elevation, Stationery Drawer

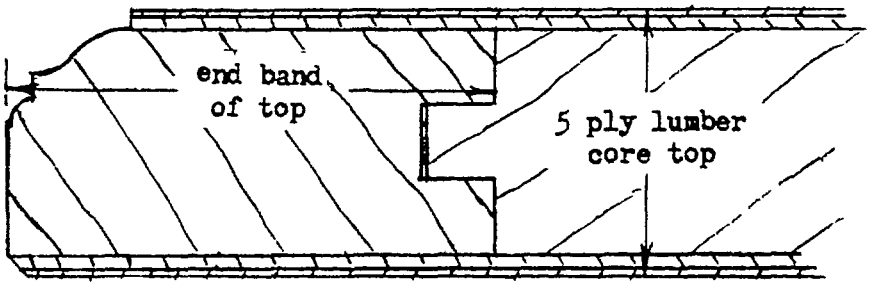


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Figure 4(7). Edge Band and Top Section



All edge bands shall be of solid walnut



Construction permitted for all Executive Type Office Furniture tops having chamfered corners. The size of the bands shall be governed by the size of chamfered corner.

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